

Chapter 25-3

Liang Shi curled up on the sofa and thought for a long time, then went to the kitchen to pour herself a glass of water.

Xu Qingzhu was sleeping soundly, and she didn't want to go up and squeeze in. She simply sat on the sofa in a daze, waiting until she felt sleepy before going upstairs.

Where to sleep at night was still a problem.

The carpet was newly changed, but she hadn't found any blankets yet.

Sharing a bed with Xu Qingzhu was obviously impossible.

So after thinking it over, the best place to rest was actually the living room sofa.

Just as she was mentally sorting through the events of these past few days, the very light sound of a door being pushed open rang out.

She looked up and saw Xu Qingya coming out of her room.

Wearing headphones, holding her phone horizontally while playing a game, probably afraid of disturbing them, she kept her voice low while coordinating with others: "Go left, left side, you idiot, can't even tell left from right."

She spoke while walking toward the kitchen, but because she wasn't watching where she was going, she accidentally tripped on the step. Her pupils immediately contracted, but she still suppressed herself from crying out. Fortunately, she didn't fall, just stumbled awkwardly, her instep getting knocked and making her grimace in pain.

However, she finally looked up and saw Liang Shi.

Liang Shi nodded at her.

Xu Qingya took off her headphones, "Sister Liang, you're not sleeping yet?"

"I'll sleep in a bit." Liang Shi drained the water in her glass and reminded her: "You should sleep early too."

Xu Qingya looked confused: "Oh."

She walked toward the kitchen, but after a few steps turned back, took off her headphones, and said seriously and solemnly: "Sister Liang, I have a question."

"What?" Liang Shi asked in a low voice.

"You married my sister, right?" Xu Qingya said.

Liang Shi nodded.

"Tonight my sister was drugged with that kind of drug. Obviously, as long as you two just... did that once, the drug's effect on her would have been resolved." Xu Qingya spoke euphemistically, but everyone could understand. Sometimes Liang Shi would marvel at the magic of language.

Using pronouns to replace words that were embarrassing to say out loud, both parties could understand the meaning.

"But you had me find a family doctor instead." Xu Qingya said: "Between you two, who has the problem?"

She stared straight at Liang Shi, as if trying to bore a hole through her.

"Logically speaking, I shouldn't be asking about these things." Xu Qingya shrugged, "You know, I'm just a minor."

Liang Shi: "..."

You still remember you're a minor?

If she hadn't said so, Liang Shi would have almost forgotten.

Xu Qingya was frighteningly precocious.

"Hey, Sister Liang, don't look at me like that." Xu Qingya said: "I've never been in a relationship, I just heard what others said. The thing about Xu Qingzhu is, her personality is too stubborn. When she likes something, she never takes the initiative to ask for it. If you give it to her, she'll take it, but if you don't give it, no matter how much she likes it, she won't open her mouth to ask for it. Also, she's never been in a relationship. In our family all these years, we've all accommodated her. So I'm wondering, is it because after you got to know her, you understood her personality, so you two don't get along?"

Liang Shi immediately shook her head, "That's not the case."

"You don't need to hide it from me." Xu Qingya said: "Actually, I don't like Xu Qingzhu either. If you don't like her, just tell me, we can badmouth her together."

Liang Shi: "...?"

She suspected Xu Qingya was fishing for information.

Liang Shi said helplessly: "I don't dislike your sister. Taking advantage of someone when they're not clear-headed isn't good."

Xu Qingya: "But you're married, it's legal."

"Your sister would be uncomfortable." Liang Shi said: "She was both drinking and drugged with an aphrodisiac. Having the family doctor help her reduce the fever and get a good night's sleep was the best choice."

Xu Qingya was still somewhat suspicious, her tone reluctant: "Fine."

"Alright, you little devil." Liang Shi smiled: "Your sister and I are doing well. Your sister's personality isn't as stubborn as you say, she's quite cute. Don't always badmouth her. If I hear you doing it again, I'll tell on you."

Xu Qingya rolled her eyes, "Go ahead and tell, I'm not afraid of her."

But she still hesitated, "You two really have no problems?"

"No problems." Liang Shi's smile was warm, even her eyes carried a few traces of indulgence, "Being able to marry your sister, I'm blessed for three lifetimes."

Xu Qingya shivered, "That's so cheesy it's killing me."

She pouted and walked toward the kitchen, waving her hand as she went, "Sister Liang, sleep early. I'm going to drink some water and then sleep too."

"Drink less." Liang Shi advised, "Drinking too much water before bed makes you puffy easily."

"Got it." Xu Qingya put her headphones back on.

Liang Shi watched her retreating figure, feeling that this little girl wasn't as bad as she had seemed when they first met.

She just had a bit of teenage rebellion.

Sharp-tongued and proud.

A stark contrast to Xu Qingzhu's personality.

Liang Shi watched for a while then turned to go upstairs, but just as she climbed two steps, she heard Xu Qingya's voice ring out in the living room.

"I'm not going back yet, I'll talk about it after school starts."

"Why am I staying? Do you even need to ask? To supervise!"

"I suspect my sister and her wife have a marriage of convenience¹. It's so late and my sister's wife still hasn't returned to the room."

Liang Shi's foot slipped and she almost fell.

She didn't believe that Xu Qingya didn't know she was here!

She clearly knew, but deliberately said this just to let her hear.

Liang Shi: "..."

"I need to observe for a while." Xu Qingya continued: "Anyway, our family is a complete mess right now. I need to make sure someone in the family can live well. Xu Qingzhu has princess syndrome, I need to see if she has a princess's fate."

"Probably not. I still think they're in a marriage of convenience."

Liang Shi: "...?"

Was it that obvious?

Liang Shi climbed the stairs with heavy steps back to the room.

When the room door closed, Xu Qingya took off her headphones, looked back at the second floor, and sent her mother a text: [They went into the same room to sleep.]

Footnotes:

¹ Marriage of convenience (形婚) - A marriage entered into for practical reasons rather than love, often to hide one's true sexual orientation or for other benefits.